Gies program health: a one-page guide

For faculty and staff with five minutes. An independent project built from public data, not affiliated with or endorsed by the University of Illinois.

The dashboard shows how Gies programs are doing, from enrollment and Illinois's standing among the 18 Big Ten universities to course grades and the Spring 2027 schedule. It is meant to point to questions worth asking, and every chart says what it can and can't show. It is on Tableau Public, and the enrollment scenarios and the registration watch are also in a Streamlit app.

The six dashboards

Dashboard	The question it answers
Overview	How are Gies programs doing? Headcount, the online share, retention, and business degrees in four numbers, then headcount by program group.
Peers	Where does Illinois stand among the Big Ten? Pick a metric; see every school, Illinois over time, and admission against yield.
Grades	How are grades changing? Grade bands by term for one course, and the Gies-wide A-range trend.
Course Watch	Where should an assessment committee look? Large courses with many grades at C or below or withdrawals, and how much sections of one course differ.
Sections	Where is capacity tight? Sections, graded students, and students per section for one course since 2016.
Registration	How is the Spring 2027 schedule filling? Daily registration curves and the share of sections closed.

How to read the charts

Blue is Illinois or Gies; gray dots are the other Big Ten schools. The shaded band is the middle half of the peers, their 25th to 75th percentiles, with Illinois left out. Hollow marks are provisional IPEDS data, which can still change. On Peers, choose a metric and whether to compare with all 18 schools or the 16 public ones. On Grades, Sections, and Registration, one course choice drives all three. The Definitions button at the top right of each dashboard opens the full definitions, and Revert in the toolbar under the dashboard resets every choice.

Six definitions

First-year retention: the share of a fall's first-time, full-time freshmen who are enrolled again the next fall. **Six-year graduation rate:** the share of an entering cohort who graduate within six years. **Yield:** the share of admitted applicants who enroll. **DFW rate:** D and F grades plus withdrawals, over graded students plus withdrawals. **Students per section:** graded students over primary sections, lectures and seminars rather than discussions or labs; it runs a little low because the grade data leave out sections of 20 or fewer students. **Closed share:** primary sections marked Closed on the course pages over primary sections with a status.

Four cautions

Most peer figures describe the whole university, not Gies; only the enrollment reports and the retention and graduation tables by college of entry are Gies figures. Grades describe grading, not learning, so a high or rising A share is a reason to look, not a verdict. A closed section isn't necessarily full, and Open (Restricted) means seats held for certain students. Small differences are noise: a rank can move on a tenth of a point.

When the data refreshes, and reporting a problem

Every Monday the pipeline checks each source for changes and republishes; during registration it records the schedule every morning, reading section status at 8:14 am Central. The dashboards pick up the data once a day. Each footer shows the last weekly refresh, and the registration charts give the date of their latest snapshot. To report a problem or ask a question, open an issue at github.com/omvyas77/program-health/issues.